

Mock Paper 8 — Expert & Beyond

Highest-difficulty tier · All 7 chapters · Concise-option, trap-based scenarios

Internal ITIL Assessment Preparation — SAP Labs · Prepared 16 July 2026

Total questions: 30 · **Maximum marks:** 30 · **Passing score:** 24/30 · **Scoring:** exact-combination only, no partial credit · **Suggested time:** 60 minutes · **Difficulty:** 100% expert-and-beyond · **Format:** mixed 2-of-4 / 3-of-5, options deliberately terse — the trap is in the scenario, not the wording.

Question Paper

Q1.

A team says their SVC redesign "already covers governance" since Design & Transition includes stakeholder sign-off steps.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Sign-off steps don't make governance an SVC activity
- B. This claim is accurate as stated
- C. Any SVC activity with approvals fully covers governance
- D. Governance stays a distinct SVS-level component

Q2.

A vendor's staff, not the client's own employees, weren't trained on a new integration; the client blames "our People dimension."

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Correctly diagnosed as the client's own People dimension
- B. Training gaps always indicate the client's People dimension
- C. The untrained party belongs to a partner, not the client
- D. More precisely a Partners and Suppliers gap
- E. Whose staff lacked training changes which dimension applies

Q3.

A team cuts a feature nobody explicitly complained about, calling it "Focus on value," without checking usage data first.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. This is a sound, complete application of the principle
- B. No complaints isn't evidence of no value
- C. Checking usage data would better support this decision
- D. Guiding Principles never require supporting data

Q4.

A live service undergoes a redesign of one module while the rest keeps serving users unchanged.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Redesign work aligns with Design/Transition activity
- B. The unchanged portion stays in Operation concurrently
- C. The whole service must sit under one single stage
- D. One service can span multiple activities at once
- E. Redesign always halts Operation-stage activity entirely

Q5.

"Architecture management" is debated for category, since it involves technical architecture.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Generally General Management, not Technical
- B. Category follows established grouping, not name
- C. Anything with "architecture" in its name is Technical
- D. Technical-sounding names always set category

Q6.

A low-impact issue will worsen fast if untouched for an hour; a high-impact issue is already stable and won't worsen further today.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. The high-impact issue automatically outranks regardless of urgency
- B. Urgency can meaningfully elevate a lower-impact issue
- C. Impact and urgency must be weighed together
- D. Stability of the high-impact issue is irrelevant to sequencing
- E. The worsening issue may reasonably need faster action first

Q7.

A workaround is applied so smoothly, repeatedly, that the team stops noticing how often the same issue recurs.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Frequent smooth workarounds prove the issue is resolved
- B. A well-working workaround removes any need to track recurrence
- C. Smoothness can mask an unaddressed recurring cause
- D. Tracking recurrence stays valuable even when workarounds work well

Q8.

First-Contact Closure rises after a knowledge-base overhaul; leadership credits it entirely to "better agent training," which didn't change.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. The credited explanation doesn't match what actually changed
- B. Training must be the cause, since FCC is training-related
- C. Correlation with the KB overhaul is irrelevant here
- D. The KB overhaul is the better-evidenced explanation
- E. Misattributing the cause can misdirect future investment

Q9.

A workaround has run flawlessly for a year; a report calls the underlying issue "resolved."

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Duration alone doesn't confirm root-cause resolution
- B. One flawless year reclassifies it as a permanent fix
- C. Calling it "resolved" may be inaccurate without confirmation
- D. Workarounds automatically become fixes given enough time

Q10.

Two changes ship the same week — a library upgrade and a new approval-workflow policy. Errors rise; a team blames the library upgrade because it "sounds more likely."

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Sounding more technical doesn't make it more likely
- B. Both concurrent changes remain plausible without isolation
- C. Isolating each change's contribution would strengthen any conclusion
- D. The non-technical change can be dismissed automatically
- E. A technical-sounding cause should always be assumed first

Q11.

A defect appears only on one product line; a team discards the unaffected lines' data as "not useful, since nothing happened there."

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Data from unaffected lines is correctly discarded
- B. Unaffected-line data is central to this comparison
- C. Only the affected line's data matters here
- D. Comparing affected vs. unaffected is the technique's core

Q12.

"Why did the batch fail? Disk full. Why? Logs not rotated." The team stops here, satisfied.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Two "whys" may not reach a genuinely actionable cause
- B. Reaching any technical detail is sufficient to stop
- C. Asking why logs weren't rotated could reveal more
- D. Stopping early risks missing a deeper systemic cause
- E. This technique mandates stopping at exactly two questions

Q13.

The most frequent incident type causes minimal business impact; a rarer type causes severe impact each time.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Frequency alone shouldn't set investigation priority
- B. The most frequent type should always go first
- C. Impact is irrelevant once frequency data exists
- D. Combining frequency with impact gives a fuller signal

Q14.

A structural risk matrix shows no single component supporting more than one service — yet one shared network segment, not listed as a "component," connects all of them.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. The matrix result alone confirms no structural risk exists
- B. Scope boundaries can miss risk paths outside listed components
- C. Since no component repeats, this is a fully complete picture
- D. An unlisted shared dependency can still be a real risk
- E. Usefulness here depends on how completely components are defined

Q15.

"The system fails if the primary database fails, and separately, if the backup fails" — each alone is sufficient.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. This should be modeled as an AND gate
- B. This should be modeled as an OR gate
- C. The word "and" doesn't necessarily mean an AND-gate
- D. Any sentence containing "and" must be modeled as AND

Q16.

A review avoids naming individuals but repeatedly stresses "the team responsible" in a tone focused on fault, not process gaps.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Avoiding names doesn't automatically make it blameless
- B. Tone and framing matter beyond just naming
- C. This is a correct example of blameless practice
- D. Blameless reviews are defined solely by absent names
- E. A learning-focused review needs substance, not just wording

Q17.

A team applies a structured Is/Is Not-style comparison despite having only vague, incomplete comparative information.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. This technique's discipline depends on reasonably solid facts
- B. Applying it with vague data risks misleading conclusions
- C. It works equally well regardless of data quality
- D. Data quality is irrelevant to any RCA technique

Q18.

A team runs Five Whys before gathering any data on which of several recurring problems is even worth investigating.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. This sequencing is optimal regardless of problem count
- B. Prioritizing among problems first would generally be more efficient
- C. Drilling without a chosen target risks wasted effort
- D. A prioritization step logically precedes deep drilling here
- E. Technique sequencing never affects investigation efficiency

Q19.

A team labels a change "Standard" because "it's always been fine," with no test-coverage or incident-history data cited.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. "Always been fine" alone is sufficient evidence
- B. Standard status requires no supporting evidence at all
- C. Standard status should rest on actual risk/test evidence
- D. An unverified assumption of safety is itself a risk

Q20.

A Change Evaluation predicted low impact; actual impact was high. The team concludes "Change Evaluation is worthless" and stops doing it.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. One inaccurate prediction doesn't make the practice worthless
- B. Discontinuing the practice is the right response here
- C. The gap is more useful for refining future evaluations
- D. This practice is only meant to be accurate, never revisited
- E. Investigating why the prediction missed is more productive

Q21.

A change is labeled "moderate risk"; the team argues this justifies skipping CAB since it's "not high risk."

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. "Not high risk" doesn't automatically mean "no review needed"
- B. Moderate-risk changes should always bypass CAB
- C. Moderate risk can still reasonably warrant proportional review
- D. Only explicitly "high risk" changes ever need review

Q22.

A change announcement reaches 100% of staff by email, but a post-change survey shows most didn't understand what would change for them.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. 100% reach confirms the communication was effective
- B. Reach and comprehension are the same measure in practice
- C. Reach without comprehension falls short of effective communication
- D. The survey reveals a real communication gap worth addressing
- E. Message clarity matters independently of delivery reach

Q23.

A team has a fully automated pipeline but rarely communicates across Dev and Ops, still working in silos.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Full pipeline automation alone confirms full DevOps adoption
- B. Genuine adoption includes cultural elements automation doesn't cover
- C. Silos are irrelevant once automation is in place
- D. This reflects incomplete adoption despite strong tooling

Q24.

A pipeline's gates pass 98% of releases; leadership proposes removing human oversight for the remaining 2% too, "for consistency."

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. A high pass rate doesn't justify zero oversight for the riskiest cases
- B. The remaining 2% may be exactly where oversight matters most
- C. Consistency alone is sufficient to remove all oversight
- D. Proportional oversight can coexist with heavy automation
- E. A 98% pass rate applies equally to the hardest 2%

Q25.

A weekly meeting has Ops report issues to Dev, but nothing about the meeting's findings ever changes future work.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. A channel without resulting change isn't fully realizing this principle's purpose
- B. Any regular Dev/Ops meeting satisfies this principle
- C. This principle is only about communication frequency
- D. It's meant to actually influence future work, not just occur

Q26.

A team deploys daily, but every deployment needs a manager's manual sign-off immediately before release.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. Daily frequency alone confirms Continuous Deployment
- B. A required manual sign-off is inconsistent with true Continuous Deployment
- C. This pattern more closely matches Continuous Delivery
- D. Deployment frequency and deployment automation are the same thing
- E. The manual gate is the deciding factor here

Q27.

A KPI trends flat for a year; leadership calls this "clearly a failure" without checking what the KPI was meant to indicate.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. A flat trend is inherently a failure regardless of context
- B. The KPI's link to its goal determines what "flat" means
- C. Without that context, "clearly a failure" is unsupported
- D. Trend direction alone is always sufficient for judgment

Q28.

"Tickets closed within SLA" rises, while customer satisfaction with resolution quality falls in the same period.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A. A rising KPI doesn't guarantee the CSF is truly improving
- B. Since the KPI rose, the CSF must be on track
- C. Satisfaction data is irrelevant once the KPI target is met
- D. Conflicting signals suggest the KPI may not fully capture the CSF
- E. A fuller picture weighs both signals together

Q29.

A "Learning & Growth" metric is "number of training sessions held," with no measure of actual skill improvement.

SELECT EXACTLY TWO

- A. Session count reflects activity, not necessarily learning outcomes
- B. This risks the same vanity-metric pattern seen elsewhere
- C. Session count is inherently the correct measure here
- D. Activity volume and outcome quality are the same thing

Q30.

An organization hits 100% of its individually-set metric targets for the quarter and declares full strategic success, without revisiting whether those targets still reflect current goals.

SELECT EXACTLY THREE

- A.** Hitting targets doesn't confirm they still reflect the right goals
- B.** Targets set in the past can drift from evolving strategy
- C.** Periodic reassessment stays valuable even amid success
- D.** 100% target achievement is definitive proof of strategic success
- E.** Once targets are hit, no further reassessment is ever warranted

Answer Key

Q	Correct	Q	Correct	Q	Correct
1	A, D	11	B, D	21	A, C
2	C, D, E	12	A, C, D	22	C, D, E
3	B, C	13	A, D	23	B, D
4	A, B, D	14	B, D, E	24	A, B, D
5	A, B	15	B, C	25	A, D
6	B, C, E	16	A, B, E	26	B, C, E
7	C, D	17	A, B	27	B, C
8	A, D, E	18	B, C, D	28	A, D, E
9	A, C	19	C, D	29	A, B
10	A, B, C	20	A, C, E	30	A, B, C

Explanations

Q1 A, D

Sign-off steps make Design & Transition thorough, not governance-equivalent — governance is a separate SVS component, always. *Trap: mistaking one activity's approval step for the whole governance function.*

Q2 C, D, E

The untrained party is external, so this is a Partners and Suppliers gap, not the client's own People dimension — whose staff is involved determines which dimension fits. *Trap: assuming "training gap" always means People, regardless of whose staff.*

Q3 B, C

Silence isn't proof of low value; genuine Focus on value needs actual usage evidence, not the absence of complaints. *Trap: treating "nobody complained" as sufficient value data.*

Q4 A, B, D

A live service can have parts in Transition and parts in Operation simultaneously — lifecycle stages aren't mutually exclusive across one service. *Trap: assuming one service = one single stage at a time.*

Q5 A, B

Architecture management sits in General Management by established grouping — "sounds technical" isn't the classification rule. *Trap: classifying by name association instead of category definition.*

Q6 B, C, E

Urgency and impact must be weighed together; a stable high-impact issue can reasonably wait behind a rapidly worsening low-impact one. *Trap: assuming "high impact" always wins regardless of urgency or stability.*

Q7 C, D

A workaround running smoothly can hide how often the underlying cause is actually recurring — tracking recurrence remains valuable regardless of workaround quality. *Trap: mistaking operational smoothness for absence of a problem.*

Q8 A, D, E

The KB overhaul, not unchanged training, better explains the FCC rise; crediting the wrong lever risks misdirected future investment. *Trap: crediting the more "expected" cause (training) over the actual evidence (KB change).*

Q9 A, C

Duration alone never confirms root-cause resolution — a workaround stays a workaround, however long it runs smoothly. *Trap: assuming time elapsed converts a workaround into a fix.*

Q10 A, B, C

"Sounds more technical" is not evidence; both concurrent changes remain plausible until isolated individually. *Trap: favoring the more technical-sounding explanation by default.*

Q11 B, D

The unaffected line's data is exactly what makes an Is/Is Not-style comparison work — discarding it removes the technique's core input. *Trap: treating "nothing happened" data as worthless instead of essential.*

Q12 A, C, D

Two "whys" reaching a technical detail (logs not rotated) doesn't mean the chain is complete — continuing could reveal a deeper systemic cause. *Trap: mistaking "we reached something technical" for "we reached the root."*

Q13 A, D

Frequency alone is an incomplete signal; combining it with impact gives the fuller basis for prioritization the rarer, severe type deserves. *Trap: equating "most frequent" with "most important to investigate."*

Q14 B, D, E

A clean matrix result only covers what's defined as a "component" — an unlisted shared dependency (the network segment) is a real risk the matrix's scope missed. *Trap: treating a technique's clean result as proof of zero risk, ignoring its scope boundaries.*

Q15 B, C

"Either alone is sufficient" is OR-gate logic regardless of the word "and" appearing in the sentence — gate type follows the actual logical relationship, not the connecting word. *Trap: reading "and" in English as AND-gate logic.*

Q16 A, B, E

Omitting names doesn't guarantee blamelessness if the tone still targets "who's responsible" — genuine learning-focus is about substance, not just the absence of proper nouns. *Trap: equating "no names used" with "genuinely blameless."*

Q17 A, B

This technique's rigor depends on solid comparative facts — applying it to vague data risks a confidently-wrong conclusion. *Trap: assuming a disciplined technique is disciplined regardless of input quality.*

Q18 B, C, D

Drilling into one problem before choosing which of several is worth investigating risks wasted effort — prioritization logically comes first. *Trap: applying a drilling technique before a prioritization step, wasting depth on the wrong target.*

Q19 C, D

"Always been fine" is habit, not evidence — Standard status should rest on actual test/incident data, and an unverified safety assumption is itself a risk. *Trap: mistaking familiarity for verified low risk.*

Q20 A, C, E

One wrong prediction is refinement data, not proof of futility — investigating why it missed beats abandoning the practice entirely. *Trap: overreacting to a single inaccurate prediction by discarding the whole practice.*

Q21 A, C

"Not high risk" isn't the same as "no risk" — moderate risk can still reasonably warrant proportional review, just not the heaviest tier. *Trap: treating "not the highest category" as "no review needed."*

Q22 C, D, E

Reach and comprehension are different measures — 100% delivery with low understanding is a real, addressable communication gap. *Trap: treating "delivered to everyone" as equivalent to "understood by everyone."*

Q23 B, D

Automation is one DevOps component; persistent silos mean the cultural half is missing — this is incomplete, not full, adoption. *Trap: equating pipeline automation with complete DevOps maturity.*

Q24 A, B, D

A 98% pass rate says nothing about the hardest 2% specifically — that's precisely where oversight has the most value, and proportional oversight can coexist with strong automation. *Trap: using an aggregate statistic to justify removing scrutiny from the exact cases it doesn't describe.*

Q25 A, D

A reporting channel that never changes future work isn't fulfilling Feedback's actual purpose — feedback is meant to influence action, not just occur on a schedule. *Trap: mistaking any recurring communication for genuine feedback.*

Q26 B, C, E

A required manual sign-off before every release is exactly what distinguishes Delivery from Deployment — frequency doesn't override that gate. *Trap: equating deployment frequency with deployment automation/type.*

Q27 B, C

"Flat" only means something once you know what the KPI was tracking toward — calling it a failure without that context is an unsupported leap. *Trap: judging a trend's direction without checking its goal-connection first.*

Q28 A, D, E

A rising KPI alongside falling satisfaction is a conflicting signal — the KPI likely isn't fully capturing the CSF, and both should be weighed together. *Trap: trusting the single rising number over a contradicting quality signal.*

Q29 A, B

Session count measures activity, not outcome — this is the same vanity-metric risk pattern applied to a Learning & Growth category.
Trap: assuming a metric fits its category just because it's labeled under that perspective.

Q30 A, B, C

Hitting old targets proves nothing about whether those targets still matter — strategy evolves, and target relevance needs periodic reassessment even after a "successful" quarter. *Trap: treating 100% target achievement as automatically equivalent to strategic success.*